

BED

1. Passage anchor

> “I usually read a few chapters each night before going to **bed**...”

Passage meaning

go to bed = go to the place where you sleep, especially in order to sleep

上床睡覺；就寢

Here, **bed** refers to the sleeping context, not merely the physical piece of furniture.

Practice

1. I usually read for twenty minutes before going to **bed**.

我通常在**上床睡覺**前讀二十分鐘書。

2. She went to **bed** early because she was tired.

她因為累了，所以很早就**上床睡覺**。

Core meanings of BED

2. bed — piece of furniture for sleeping

= piece of furniture designed for sleeping or resting on

床；睡床

Examples

1. The cat was sleeping on the **bed**.

貓正在**床上**睡覺。

2. There is a small **bed** beside the window.

窗邊有一張小**床**。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. single / double / king-size bed

= different types or sizes of beds

單人床 / 雙人床 / 特大床

Examples

1. The room has a ****double bed****.
房間裡有一張****雙人床****。
2. We booked a room with two ****single beds****.
我們訂了一間有兩張****單人床****的房間。

Sleeping / bedtime state

4. go to bed

= go to sleep or prepare to sleep
****上床睡覺；就寢****

This is the exact passage use.

Examples

1. I usually ****go to bed**** at eleven.
我通常十一點****上床睡覺****。
2. The children ****went to bed**** early.
孩子們很早就****上床睡覺****了。

5. be in bed

= be lying in bed, usually because sleeping, resting, or ill
****在床上；臥床****

Examples

1. She was already ****in bed**** when I called.
我打電話時她已經****上床了****。
2. He stayed ****in bed**** all morning because he was ill.
他因為生病，整個早上都****臥床休息****。

6. get out of bed

= leave the bed after sleeping or resting

****起床；下床****

Examples

1. I didn't want to ****get out of bed**** this morning.

我今天早上不想****起床****。

2. He slowly ****got out of bed****.

他慢慢****下床****。

Place for a patient

7. bed — hospital bed / patient capacity

= a bed available for a patient, often used to represent treatment capacity

****病床；床位****

Examples

1. The hospital added twenty new ****beds****.

醫院增加了二十張****病床****。

2. There were no ****beds**** available that night.

那晚沒有可用的****床位****。

This can refer to actual beds or institutional capacity.

8. hospital bed

= bed used by a patient in a hospital

****病床****

Examples

1. He spent three days in a ****hospital bed****.

他在****病床****上住了三天。

2. The patient was moved to another ****bed****.

病人被轉移到另一張****病床****。

Bottom of river / sea / lake

9. bed — bottom of a body of water

= ground forming the bottom of a river, lake, sea, etc.

河床；湖床；海床

Examples

1. The river **bed** was covered with stones.

河床上滿是石頭。

2. Researchers studied the sea **bed**.

研究人員研究了**海床**。

Major distinct sense.

10. riverbed / seabed / lakebed

= bottom surface of a river, sea, or lake

河床 / 海床 / 湖床

Examples

1. The **riverbed** was almost dry.

河床幾乎乾了。

2. The cable lies on the **seabed**.

電纜鋪設在**海床**上。

Layer / deposit

11. bed — layer of rock, sand, coal, etc.

= naturally occurring layer of material

層；礦層；岩層

Examples

1. The geologists examined a **bed of limestone**.

地質學家研究了一層**石灰岩層**。

2. Coal was found in a deep **bed**.

煤礦在深層**煤層**中被發現。

Established geological sense.

12. coal bed / rock bed

= layer containing coal or rock material

煤層；岩層

Examples

1. The mine follows a narrow **coal bed**.

礦場沿著狹窄的**煤層**開採。

2. The road was built over a stable **rock bed**.

道路建在穩固的**岩層**之上。

Garden plot

13. bed — area of soil for plants

= prepared area of ground where flowers, vegetables, or other plants are grown

花圃；苗床；種植區

Examples

1. She planted roses in the flower **bed**.

她在**花圃**裡種了玫瑰。

2. The vegetable **beds** need watering.

菜園的**種植畦**需要澆水。

14. flower bed

= area of soil planted with flowers

花圃；花壇

Examples

1. The garden has several colorful **flower beds**.
花園裡有幾個色彩繽紛的**花壇**。

2. Don't step into the **flower bed**.
不要踩進**花圃**。

15. seedbed

A. prepared place where seeds are planted

苗床

B. figurative place where ideas/problems develop

溫床

Examples

1. The seedlings were started in a **seedbed**.
幼苗最初種在**苗床**裡。

2. Corruption can become a **seedbed** for further instability.
貪腐可能成為進一步不穩定的**溫床**。

Useful lexicalized extension.

Vehicle platform

16. bed — rear platform of a truck

= flat open part of a truck used to carry goods
貨斗；車斗

Examples

1. The boxes were loaded into the truck **bed**.
箱子被裝進卡車的**貨斗**。

2. Tools were lying in the pickup **bed**.
工具放在皮卡車的**車斗**裡。

Major AmE vehicle sense.

17. truck bed / pickup bed

= cargo-carrying rear section of a truck or pickup

卡車貨斗；皮卡車斗

Examples

1. The bicycle fit easily in the **truck bed**.
單車很容易放進卡車**貨斗**。
2. They covered the **pickup bed** before the rain.
下雨前他們把皮卡**車斗**蓋好。

Supporting base / foundation

18. bed — supporting layer or base

= layer or surface on which something rests

底層；基床；基座

Examples

1. The pipes were laid on a **bed of sand**.
管道鋪在一層**砂床**上。
2. The road was built on a gravel **bed**.
道路建在碎石**基床**上。

This is a broad technical extension from “something that supports.”

Machinery

19. bed — machine base

= heavy base or frame supporting the working parts of a machine

機床床身；底座

Examples

1. The lathe **bed** must remain rigid.
車床的**床身**必須保持剛性。
2. The machine was mounted on a solid **bed**.
機器安裝在牢固的**底座**上。

Technical but established.

Food / serving layer

20. bed of something

= layer of food or material on which something else is placed

一層..... ; 墊底的.....

Examples

1. The fish was served on a **bed of rice**.
魚放在一層**米飯**上端上來。
2. The vegetables sat on a **bed of lettuce**.
蔬菜放在一層**生菜**上。

Productive culinary construction.

Verb: put to bed / settle

21. put someone to bed

= help someone, especially a child, get ready for sleep

哄 / 安頓某人上床睡覺

Examples

1. She **put the children to bed** at nine.
她九點把孩子們**安頓上床睡覺**。
2. He read a story before **putting his son to bed**.
他在**哄兒子上床睡覺**前讀了一個故事。

Verb: embed / fix in material

22. bed something in

= fix or place something firmly in a supporting material

嵌入；安放固定

Examples

1. The stones were **bedded in concrete**.

石頭被**嵌入混凝土中固定**。

2. The pipe must be properly **bedded in sand**.

管道必須正確地**安放在砂層中**。

Technical construction use.

23. bed in

= become settled, established, or fully functional after an initial period

逐漸磨合；穩定下來

Especially BrE.

Examples

1. The new system needs time to **bed in**.

新系統需要時間**磨合並穩定下來**。

2. The changes are beginning to **bed in**.

這些改變開始**逐漸穩定下來**。

Useful modern figurative extension.

Verb: provide with a bed / sleep

24. bed down

A. settle down to sleep somewhere

****躺下睡；安頓過夜****

1. We ****bedded down**** for the night.
我們****安頓下來過夜****。

B. settle animals for the night

****給動物鋪墊、安置過夜****

2. The horses were ****bedded down**** in the stable.
馬匹被****安置在馬廄過夜****。

Sexual use

25. bed someone

Literary/informal:

= have sex with someone

****與某人發生性關係****

Examples

1. The novel depicts him trying to ****bed**** several characters.
小說描寫他試圖與幾個角色****發生性關係****。
2. This verb use is more literary or blunt than neutral everyday wording.
這種動詞用法比一般中性表達更文學化或直接。

Distinct sense, but register-sensitive.

Fixed expressions

26. make the bed

= arrange sheets, blankets, pillows, etc. neatly after sleeping

****整理床鋪；鋪床****

Examples

1. I ****make my bed**** every morning.
我每天早上都會****整理床鋪****。

2. She forgot to **make the bed**.

她忘了**鋪床**。

27. take to your bed

= stay in bed because of illness or emotional distress

臥床；因病不起

Examples

1. He **took to his bed** with a fever.

他發燒後便**臥床休息**。

2. She **took to her bed** for several days.

她**臥床了幾天**。

28. get on the wrong side of the bed

= be in a bad mood, especially from the beginning of the day

一起床就心情不好；無緣無故脾氣差

Examples

1. Did you **get out of bed on the wrong side** this morning?

你今天是不是**一起床就心情很差**？

2. He seems to have **got up on the wrong side of the bed**.

他今天似乎**一早就心情不好**。

29. make your bed and lie in it

= accept the consequences of your own decisions or actions

自作自受；自己造成的後果自己承擔

Examples

1. He made the decision himself; now he must **make his bed and lie in it**.

決定是他自己做的，現在只好**自己承擔後果**。

2. You chose this path, so you may have to ****lie in the bed you made****.

這條路是你自己選的，所以可能要****承擔自己的選擇所帶來的結果****。

30. put something to bed

= finish, settle, or dispose of a matter so it no longer needs attention

****把事情處理完；讓某事告一段落****

Examples

1. Let's ****put this issue to bed****.

我們把這個問題****徹底處理完吧****。

2. The new evidence finally ****put the rumor to bed****.

新證據終於讓那個傳聞****平息下來****。

Very useful figurative expression.

31. bed of roses

= easy, pleasant, trouble-free situation

****安逸舒適的生活；一帆風順的處境****

Often negative:

> life is not a bed of roses

Examples

1. Running a business is not a ****bed of roses****.

經營生意並非總是****一帆風順****。

2. Their early years were far from a ****bed of roses****.

他們早年的生活一點也不****安逸輕鬆****。

Related forms

32. bedding

A. sheets, blankets, etc.

****床上用品；寢具****

1. The hotel provides clean ****bedding****.
酒店提供乾淨的****床上用品****。

B. material used as a supporting layer

****墊層；鋪墊材料****

2. Sand was used as ****bedding**** for the pipe.
砂被用作管道的****墊層材料****。

33. bedroom

= room containing a bed, used mainly for sleeping
****睡房；臥室****

Examples

1. The apartment has two ****bedrooms****.
公寓有兩間****睡房****。
2. Her ****bedroom**** overlooks the garden.
她的****臥室****望向花園。

34. bedside

= area beside a bed
****床邊****

Examples

1. There is a lamp on the ****bedside table****.
****床頭櫃****上有一盞燈。
2. She sat at his ****bedside****.
她坐在他的****床邊****。

35. bedridden

= unable to leave bed because of illness or weakness

****臥床不起的****

Examples

1. He was ****bedridden**** for several weeks.

他****臥床不起****了幾星期。

2. The illness left her temporarily ****bedridden****.

疾病使她暫時****無法下床****。

Key contrasts

36. bed vs bedroom

****bed****

= furniture you sleep on

****床****

****bedroom****

= room where the bed is located

****睡房****

37. bed vs mattress

****bed****

= entire sleeping furniture setup

****mattress****

= padded part you lie on

****床褥；床墊****

A mattress is one component of a bed.

38. bed vs sleep

****bed****

= place/furniture or bedtime state

****sleep****

= physiological state of being asleep

****睡眠****

Compare:

> go to ****bed****

> 上床睡覺

> go to ****sleep****

> 入睡

You can go to bed without immediately falling asleep.

39. go to bed vs go to sleep

****go to bed****

= physically go to your sleeping place / begin bedtime

****上床****

****go to sleep****

= actually enter the sleeping state

****睡著；入睡****

This distinction is especially important for the passage.

40. bed vs couch/sofa

****bed****

= primarily designed for sleeping

****sofa/couch****

= primarily designed for sitting, though people may sleep on one.

Meaning map

The central literal concept of ****bed**** is:

****a flat supporting place on which something rests****

From this develop:

Sleeping

bed

→ **床**

Passage

go to bed

→ **上床睡覺**

Hospital

hospital bed

→ **病床 / 床位**

Water

riverbed / seabed

→ **河床 / 海床**

Gardening

flower bed

→ **花圃 / 花壇**

Geology

rock/coal bed

→ **岩層 / 煤層**

Vehicle

truck bed

→ **貨斗**

Construction

sand bed

→ **基床 / 墊層**

Machinery

machine bed

→ **機床床身 / 底座**

Food

bed of rice

→ **一層墊底的米飯**

The support/settling idea also develops into verbs:

Construction

bed something in

→ **嵌入固定**

Organizational change

bed in

→ **逐漸磨合穩定**

Sleep

bed down

→ **安頓過夜**

The passage uses the ordinary bedtime expression:

> **before going to bed**

> → **上床睡覺前**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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bed — sleeping furniture	用來睡覺或休息的床
go to bed	上床準備睡覺 / 就寢
be in bed	躺在床上，通常在睡覺、休息或生病
get out of bed	起床 / 下床
bed — hospital capacity	病床；亦可指醫院可收治病人的床位
bed — river/sea/lake	河、海、湖等水體的底部；河床 / 海床 / 湖床
bed — geological layer	岩石、煤、砂等自然形成的一層；岩層 / 礦層
bed — garden	專門種植花草、蔬菜等的一塊土壤；花園 / 花壇
flower bed	種植花卉的花園 / 花壇
seedbed — literal	播種、育苗用的苗床
seedbed — figurative	某種思想、問題或現象滋長的溫床
bed — truck	卡車 / 皮卡後方用來載貨的車斗 / 貨斗

bed — supporting layer	讓物件安放其上的基床 / 墊層	
bed — machine base	支撐機械主要部件的床身 / 底座	
bed of food/material	墊在另一物件下的一層食物或材料	
put someone to bed	安頓 / 哄某人上床睡覺	
bed something in	把某物嵌入或固定在支撐材料中	
bed in	新制度、設備、安排等逐漸磨合並穩定	
bed down	安頓下來睡覺 / 過夜	
bed someone	較文學 / 直接：與某人發生性關係	
make the bed	整理床單、被子等；鋪床	
take to your bed	因病等而臥床	
get up on the wrong side of the bed	一早就心情差、脾氣不好	
make your bed and lie in it	自己作出的選擇所造成的後果要自己承擔	
put something to bed	把問題、傳聞等徹底處理完 / 讓其告一段落	
bed of roses	安逸、沒有困難的處境，常用於否定	
bedding — sleep	床單、被子等床上用品	
bedding — technical	支撐管道等的墊層材料	
bedroom	用來睡覺的房間；睡房 / 臥室	
bedside	床旁的位置；床邊	
bedridden	因病或虛弱而無法下床；臥床不起的	

Passage recap

> “I usually read a few chapters each night before going to **bed**...”

Here:

****go to bed**** = ****to go to your sleeping place, usually in preparation for sleep****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **上床睡覺**

* **就寢**

Natural contextual translation:

****我通常每晚睡前看幾章。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****go to bed****

= ****to go to the place where you sleep, especially because you intend to sleep****

****上床睡覺；就寢****

The key distinction is:

> **go to bed**

> → 上床、開始準備睡覺

versus:

> **go to sleep**

> → 真正進入睡眠狀態

And the wider polysemy branches far beyond furniture:

> river **bed**

> → 河床

> flower **bed**

> → 花圃

> truck **bed**

> → 車斗

> hospital **bed**

> → 病床

In the passage, however, **bed** belongs to the ordinary **sleep/bedtime** expression.